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UAE TO INVEST €40 BILLION IN GERMANY

Mohamed's visit strengthens partnership in technology, energy and industry

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has announced a €40 billion investment in Germany across strategic sectors including industry, advanced technology, artificial intelligence, digital infrastructure and energy.

The announcement comes amid growing momentum in UAE-German relations and coincides with the state visit of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan to Germany.

The investment will significantly expand the UAE's presence in one of Europe's largest and most industrially and technologically advanced economies. The UAE is seeking to benefit from German expertise in sectors aligned with its priorities for developing a future economy based on knowledge, technology and innovation.

The planned investment is intended to go beyond capital deployment, bringing together UAE investment capabilities with Germany's industrial, technological and innovation base. The initiative is expected to strengthen shared economic interests and reinforce the UAE and Germany's roles as partners in developing the industries and technologies of the future.

Meeting German President

Meanwhile, Sheikh Mohamed and Frank-Walter Steinmeier, President of Germany, yesterday discussed ways to build on the longstanding ties between the



■ Sheikh Mohamed and German President Steinmeier walk past a guard of honour in Berlin, Germany, yesterday.

UAE and Germany, in support of their shared interests and strategic partnership. The discussions took place during a meeting between the two leaders at Villa Borsig in Berlin. Sheikh Mohamed and President Steinmeier also reviewed a number of regional and international developments,

including efforts to promote lasting peace in the Middle East as a means of strengthening regional security and stability.

Sheikh Mohamed noted that the UAE and Germany share longstanding ties of cooperation and friendship that date back to before the establishment of the

UAE. He said that, over more than 50 years, relations between the two countries have continued to develop through a number of key milestones, culminating in their strategic partnership. This progress, he remarked, reflects a shared commitment to further strengthening coopera-

tion in ways that advance mutual interests and contribute to the prosperity of both countries and their peoples.

Sheikh Mohamed commended President Steinmeier's role in advancing relations between the UAE and Germany. He also highlighted the contribution of

the UAE's German community to strengthening ties between the peoples of both countries, as well as the important role of German companies in bolstering bilateral economic relations.

Meeting Chancellor Merz

Later, Sheikh Mohamed met Friedrich Merz, Chancellor of Germany, and discussed opportunities to strengthen cooperation across key economic, technological and cultural fields in support of the strategic partnership between the two countries.

Sheikh Mohamed said that the UAE views its relationship with Germany as a long-term strategic partnership built on more than 50 years of cooperation, trust and mutual interests. He voiced confidence that the launch of the Strategic Dialogue announced during the visit would provide a new framework for the wide-ranging UAE-Germany partnership.

The UAE President also visited the German Bundestag, the national parliament of Germany.

Sheikh Mohamed then visited the Neue Wache memorial in Berlin. He laid a wreath inside the Neue Wache, which serves as Germany's central memorial to the victims of war and tyranny.

Thereafter, Sheikh Mohamed met with Kai Wegner, Governing Mayor of Berlin.

Following the meeting, Sheikh Mohamed wrote an entry in the Golden Book of Berlin, the city's official register of distinguished visitors that is traditionally signed by visiting heads of state.

— With inputs from WAM
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DWC's 2nd runway to be ready for take-off by end of next year

Griffiths says first phase will provide capacity for 150 million passengers

DUBAI

BY MARK THOMPSON
Editor-in-Chief

Dubai World Central's (DWC) second runway is expected to open by the end of 2027, marking the next major step in the expansion of Al Maktoum International Airport as Dubai presses ahead with plans to build the world's largest airport.

The runway opening will be the next major milestone in the development of DWC, Dubai Airports CEO Paul Griffiths said, as the emirate continues to expand aviation capacity despite the disruption faced by the sector this year.

Next big milestone

"The opening of the second runway will be the next major milestone for DWC," Griffiths said during a media briefing hosted by the Dubai Media Office. The newest passenger terminal at Al Maktoum International Airport is being developed as Dubai's long-

The airport's first additional capacity is expected to come online in the early 2030s, when the first phase of the new passenger terminal is due to open.

term aviation hub and is planned to eventually handle up to 260 million passengers a year.

The airport's first additional capacity is expected to come online in the early 2030s, when the first phase of the new passenger terminal is due to open. The completed airport is planned to house five runways.

Griffiths said the first phase will provide capacity for 150 million passengers.

Construction is already under way, with Griffiths describing the scale of activity at the site as "quite incredible".

"17,000 piles are already in the ground, and 45 million cubic metres of earth has been moved at DWC," Griffiths had told *Gulf News* in an earlier interview.

The expansion is being driven by the need to accommodate Dubai's long-term aviation

growth, with Dubai International Airport expected to reach its current capacity limits in the coming years.

flydubai first?

The first airline move from DXB to DWC is not confirmed. However, Griffiths said flydubai would probably be the first airline to shift part of its operation, with an initial move potentially involving five or six aircraft next year.

"The first mover actually will probably be flydubai," Griffiths said. "That will move part of their operation to the new airport over the next few years, probably starting next year."

Griffiths said the initial move could involve five or six aircraft, allowing the carriers to continue expanding as DXB approaches its limits. "DWC will start the transition and then we will gradually replace slots with more expansion," he said.

Griffiths said the long-term airport strategy remains unchanged despite recent disruption.

"Everything full speed ahead at DWC International is still opening in the early 2030s," he said.

SEE ALSO P-II

Apple's first foldable iPhone Duo lands at Dh8,499

UAE availability expected from October 23

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Apple has entered the foldable phone market with iPhone Duo, its first folding iPhone, priced from Dh8,499 in the UAE.

The phone opens to reveal a 7.6-inch Super Retina XDR display, 50 per cent larger than the iPhone 18 Pro Max screen, while the 5.4-inch outer display provides 90 per cent of the screen area of the iPhone 18 Pro.

Both displays support ProMotion, Always On and peak outdoor brightness of 3,000 nits. The inner screen uses a nano-texture finish designed to reduce glare and make the fold crease less visible.

Two apps at once

iOS 27.1 brings Split View to iPhone Duo, allowing users to run two apps side by side for the first time on an iPhone. Netflix, Zoom and Slack are among apps already adapted for the folding design.

The phone runs on Apple's A20 Pro chip and uses



two batteries, one on either side.

Apple says users can get up to 31 hours of video playback on the inner screen or 44 hours using the outer display.

48MP cameras

iPhone Duo carries 48MP Main and Ultra Wide cameras, while its folding design lets users preview rear-camera selfies on the outer display.

The camera can also record 4K video at 120 frames per second in Dolby Vision.

"iPhone Duo is the most transformational change to iPhone since the original," Apple CEO John Ternus said.

Pre-orders begin October 16, with UAE availability from October 23. Prices start at Dh8,499 for 256GB, rising to Dh13,599 for 2TB.

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